Yours, and the field.

Colour, type, layout, motifs and voice.

← all documents · Kat Titterton · San Francisco

Essence

Pink is yours; green is the field. Every Datum Line surface is one idea drawn twice: a single lab's cells, and everyone else running the same line. The design stays quiet (off-white ground, near-black ink, grey for everyone else) so the two colours carry the meaning whenever they appear.

The register is a lab notebook that went to design school: precise numbers, monospace labels, generous space, one idea per surface.

01 Colour

Two meaning colours, a grey scale, nothing else. Pink and green are a magenta–green pair, chosen to stay distinct under red–green colour blindness.

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	MEANS	USE
accent (pink)	#be1e74	#ef74ad	yours: this lab, this plate, the thing in question	one emphasis per surface; headline accents; your data point
green	#0f8f6c	#3fe0a0	the field: everyone running the same line	reference rings, chance lines, eyebrow labels, "in distribution"
ink	#14171a	#f6f7f7	text	headings, names, primary text

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK	MEANS	USE
soft	#454c50	#c9cfd1	body	running text
muted	#666e72	#949c9f	secondary	labels, captions, byline
quiet	#949c9f	#6f777a	everyone else	grey points, dashes, inactive dots
rule	#d3d8da	#2a2f33	structure	hairlines, table rules, card borders
ground	#f6f7f7	#14171a	page	light slides and documents
surface	#ffffff	#1c2024	card	figure and content cards

Dark slides (04, 05, 06, 07) use ink as the ground and the dark column throughout. Grey is never decoration: it always means "everyone else".

02 Type

One sans for words, one mono for things you could measure, a serif only for math.

FAMILY	ROLE	WEIGHTS	DETAILS
Archivo	headlines, body, figure titles	400, 500, 600, 700	headlines 600–700, tracking −0.03em, line height 1.05
IBM Plex Mono	eyebrows, labels, numbers, captions, timestamps	400, 500	eyebrows uppercase, tracking +0.1em
Source Serif 4	equations and variables only	400 italic	never for running text

LEVEL	SLIDE (1280 × 720)	DOCUMENT	FONT
Title	84	40–64 (fluid)	Archivo 700
Headline	44	26	Archivo 600
Lead	26–30	19	Archivo 500
Body	18–21	17	Archivo 400
Label, eyebrow	13–15	13	Plex Mono, uppercase
Caption	13	13	Plex Mono, muted

Nothing on a slide is smaller than 13 px. The headline's key phrase takes the accent: "*Control* is an illusion", "Identity, yes. *Behaviour, no.*"

Fig. 1 **Three families, three jobs**

ARCHIVO 700

Control is an illusion.

IBM PLEX MONO 500

99.9% · CHANCE 9.1% · n = 93,228

SOURCE SERIF 4 ITALIC

$$d = \| E[e \mid plate] - E[e \mid field, c] \|_{\Sigma}$$

03 Layout and surfaces

ELEMENT	SPEC
Slide frame	1280 × 720, padding 52–56
Top row	eyebrow left: slide number in muted mono; tag right: green mono uppercase

ELEMENT	SPEC
Headline row	headline left at a fixed width; one supporting line to its right, or nothing
Cards	surface white, radius 14, soft shadow (1 px contact + 12 px blur), padding 16–22
Spacing	multiples of 4; 16 between cards, 20 between rows
Progress	ten dashes bottom left, 9 × 4; the current one 20 wide in the accent
Ground	off-white with two faint glows: pink from the top right, green from the bottom left, each under 8% opacity
Documents	780 px column, pink-to-green rule under the masthead, numbered sections

Leave space empty rather than fill it with words. A slide carries its title, one figure and at most one line of type; the rest goes to the script or the caption.

04 Motifs and icons

MOTIF	WHAT IT IS	WHERE
The dial	a pink dot drifting inside a green ring, on a white disc with a tick scale	title slide, favicon
The rule	a 3 px line fading pink to green	under document mastheads, on card tops
The key	a pink dot labelled *your cells*, a green ring labelled *the field*	wherever the two colours first appear
Checks	a filled green circle with a white tick; a grey dash for no	comparison tables
Line icons	24 px grid, 1.6 px stroke, round caps and joins, one colour	pipelines, roadmaps, the ask

Icons stay literal: a vial for a cell line, a plate grid for a screen, a lock for "stays yours", a stamp for the certificate. No filled icons, no emoji, and no third-party logos; institutions are named in type.

05 Figures and data

Figures carry the argument; text only points at them.

RULE	IN PRACTICE
Colour roles are fixed	pink = this plate or lab; green = the field, the reference, chance; grey = everyone else
One highlight	one pink mark per figure; if two things need emphasis, it is two figures
Number every figure	"Fig. n" in pink mono, then a title that states the finding, then a one-line caption
Captions carry the sourcing	n, what was held out, the null, the results file or reference number
References are verified	a numbered reference only if the source was opened and checked; pending work says "pending"
Math is typeset	serif italic with numbered equations, never code-style text
Charts are drawn from data	never hand-placed points; axes titled in plain words

Captions can be switched off for live presenting; the shared link and PDFs always show them.

06 Voice and writing

Precise, spare, a little dry. Say the number, say where it came from, stop.

DO	INSTEAD OF
"99.9% of untreated wells name their own lab; chance is 9%"	"a highly accurate model"
"the field", "your cells", "a reference"	"federated", "corpus", "platform"
"pending" on anything not yet run	implying a result exists
"Published with" for coauthor institutions	"partners" before anyone has agreed
colons, semicolons, commas, full stops	em dashes
one idea per slide, one thesis per section	lists of benefits

Headlines are claims, not topics: "Eleven labs. Eleven normals.", not "Inter-laboratory variation". Pairs land hardest: *Identity, yes. Behaviour, no. Confidence without control.*

07 Don't

- Add a third colour, or use pink and green for anything but *yours* and *the field*.
- Recolour or redraw anyone else's logo.
- Put two sentences on a slide where one will do, or text under 13 px.
- Use gradients, except the pink-to-green rule and the faint background glows.
- Let text touch a border: every label has room to breathe, and every layout is checked at phone width.
- Show an unverified number as a fact.

Tokens for code

Copy these into any page; light and dark come for free.

```
css :root { --accent: #be1e74; --green: #0f8f6c; --ink: #14171a; --soft: #454c50; --muted: #666e72; --quiet: #949c9f; --rule: #d3d8da; --ground: #f6f7f7; --surface: #ffffff; --font-sans: 'Archivo', 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif; --font-mono: 'IBM Plex Mono', Menlo, monospace; --font-math: 'Source Serif 4', Georgia, serif; --radius: 14px; }
```

```
@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) { :root:not([data-theme="light"]) { --accent: #ef74ad; --green: #3fe0a0; --ink: #f6f7f7; --soft: #c9cfd1; --muted: #949c9f; --quiet: #6f777a; --rule: #2a2f33; --ground: #14171a; --surface: #1c2024; } }
```

Fonts load from Google Fonts: Archivo 400–700, IBM Plex Mono 400–500, Source Serif 4 400 italic.